Subject:
Behavioral Sciences

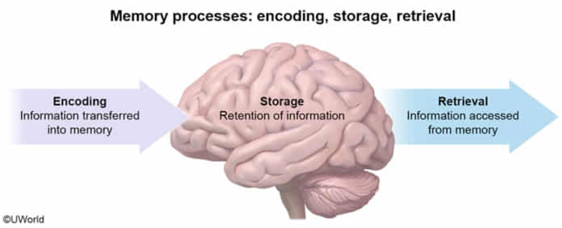
System:
Learning, Memory, and Cognition

When first memorizing neuroanatomical structures and their functions, a student associates the amygdala, which starts with the letters A-M-Y and is involved in processing emotions, with her "emotional" friend named Amy. This scenario illustrates:

- A. the elaboration likelihood model.
- B. the availability heuristic. [5%]
- ✔ C. an encoding strategy. [62%]
- D. associative learning. [31%]

Correct
62% answered correctly

Explanation:



Memory involves **encoding**, the **transfer of information** into long-term **memory**; storage (retaining the information); and retrieval (accessing the information). Some information is processed automatically with little effort (eg, registering the characters on a license plate as letters or numbers), but to encode information, attention and effortful processing are often required (eg, encoding a specific license plate takes effort).

Elaboration is an example of an encoding strategy that can enhance memory. With *elaboration*, new information is meaningfully associated with previously known information. This effortful, deep processing tends to result in more connections to the new material, improving learning.

A scenario in which a student meaningfully associates the name and function of the amygdala (ie, new information) to her "emotional" friend named Amy (ie, previously known information) illustrates elaboration, an *encoding strategy*.

(Choice A) The elaboration likelihood model (ELM) describes a message's *persuasiveness* based on how deeply or superficially it is processed and the characteristics of the audience (eg, motivation). A scenario in which a student links new information to old information does not illustrate the ELM.

(Choice B) The availability heuristic is the tendency to judge how common or likely something is based on how easily it is recalled (eg, assuming that shark attacks are common because one was recently reported on the news). A scenario in which a student links new information to old information does not illustrate the availability heuristic.

(Choice D) Associative learning is the linking of two events or stimuli. For example, in operant conditioning, a behavior is associated with a consequence (ie, reinforcement or punishment). A scenario in which a student links new information to old information does not illustrate associative learning.

Educational objective:
Encoding involves the transfer of information into long-term memory. Information that is attended to and processed more deeply tends to be remembered better.

Time spent: 0 sec	**QID**:402266
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